

QM-2
Oct-7

Today : Time - dependent Pert. theory (5.5.1-2,
5.7.1)

Warm-up : Time evolution

Given : Const. Hamiltonian H_0

$$\text{T. I. S. E. : } H_0 |n\rangle = E_n |n\rangle$$

$$\text{T. D. S. E. : } i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} |\psi, t\rangle = H_0 |\psi, t\rangle$$

$$\text{Initial state : } |\psi, t=0\rangle = |n\rangle$$

$$\text{Show : } |\psi, t\rangle = e^{-iE_n t/\hbar} |n\rangle$$

Solves T.D.S.E

$$\Rightarrow i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} |\psi, t\rangle = E_n |\psi, t\rangle$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} |\psi, t\rangle = -\frac{E_n i}{\hbar} |\psi, t\rangle$$

$$\Rightarrow |\psi, t\rangle = e^{\frac{-E_n i}{\hbar} t}$$

assuming $t_0 = 0$

$$\Rightarrow |\psi, t\rangle = e^{\frac{-E_n i (t-0)}{\hbar}}$$

$$\Rightarrow |\psi, t\rangle = e^{-E_n i t / \hbar} \cdot e^{-E_n i (0) / \hbar}$$

$\uparrow$

$\downarrow$

$\downarrow$

$\downarrow$

• General hamiltonian $H(t)$

$$\text{T.D.S.E} : i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} |\alpha, t\rangle = H(t) |\alpha, t\rangle$$

• time evolution operator : $|\alpha, t\rangle = U(t, t_0) |\alpha, t_0\rangle$
for any $|\alpha, t_0\rangle$

plugging in T.D.S.E

$$\Rightarrow i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} U(t, t_0) |\alpha, t_0\rangle = H(t) U(t, t_0) |\alpha, t_0\rangle$$

→

$$i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} U(t, t_0) = H(t) U(t, t_0)$$

time evolution
operator
satisfies this
condition

special $H(t) = H_0$

$$i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} U_0(t, t_0) = H_0 U_0(t, t_0)$$

Solution:

$$U_0(t, t_0) = e^{-iH_0(t-t_0)/\hbar}$$

initial condition: $U(t, t) = \mathbb{1}$

Ex: $|a, 0\rangle = |n\rangle$

$$\begin{aligned} |a, t\rangle &= e^{-iH_0(t-0)/\hbar} |n\rangle \\ &= e^{-iE_n t/\hbar} |n\rangle \end{aligned}$$

T.D.P.T

- suppose: $H(t) = H_0 + V(t)$
- want to find $U(t, t_0)$ for this hamiltonian

Solve: $i\hbar \frac{\partial}{\partial t} U(t, t_0) = (H_0 + V(t)) U(t, t_0)$

Proof. *
Sommerfeld special

this equation can be written as an integral equation:

$$U(t, t_0) = U_0(t, t_0) + \frac{1}{i\hbar} \int_{t_0}^t dt_1 \underbrace{U_0(t, t_1)}_{\text{unperturbed}} \underbrace{V(t_1)}_{\text{exact}} U(t_1, t_0)$$

power series
can be
used to find
solution.

where, $U_0(t, t_0) = e^{-iH_0(t-t_0)/\hbar}$

ANALOGY:

$$y = 1 + r + r^2 + \dots$$

$$= 1 + r \left(1 + r + r^2 + \dots \right)$$

$\hookrightarrow y$

$$\boxed{y = 1 + ry}$$

$$= 1 + r + r^2 y$$

and so on

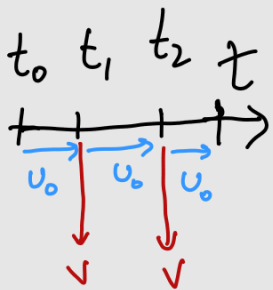
(keep repeating would land
push y off to infinity)

$\hookrightarrow$ this analogy can be applied to the

integral above

$$U(t, t_0) = U_0(t, t_0) + \frac{1}{i\hbar} \int_{t_0}^t dt_2 U_0(t, t_2) V(t_2) \left[\right.$$

time axis



evolves under unperturbed hamiltonian from t_0 to t_1

Experiences perturbation at t_1

$t_1 \rightarrow t_2$ again unperturbed hamiltonian

perturbation at t_2 again.

expanding this again.

$$= U_0(t, t_0) + \frac{1}{i\hbar} \int_{t_0}^t dt_2 U_0(t, t_2) V(t_2) U_0(t_2, t_0) + \frac{1}{i\hbar} \int_{t_0}^{t_2} dt_1 U_0(t_2, t_1) V(t_1) U(t_1, t_0) \left[\right.$$

$$+ \left(\frac{1}{i\hbar} \right)^2 \int_{t_0}^t dt_2 \int_{t_0}^{t_2} dt_1 \underbrace{U_0(t_2, t_2)}_{\text{blue}} \underbrace{V(t_2)}_{\text{red}} \underbrace{U_0(t_2, t_1)}_{\text{blue}} \underbrace{V(t_1)}_{\text{red}} \underbrace{U_0(t_1, t_0)}_{\text{blue}} + O(V^3)$$

$$t \geq t_2 \geq t_1 \geq t_0$$

← time evolution

this problem can also be solved by another approach:

Interaction Picture

Define: $|a, t\rangle_I = e^{iH_0 t/\hbar} |a, t\rangle$

Schrödinger
test

Example: $|\psi, t\rangle = e^{-iE_n t/\hbar} |n\rangle, H(t) = H_0$

$$|\psi, t\rangle_I = e^{\underbrace{iH_0 t/\hbar}_{E_n}} e^{-iE_n t/\hbar} |n\rangle$$

$\hookrightarrow 1$

$$\Rightarrow |\psi, t\rangle_I = |n\rangle$$

evolution of $|a, t\rangle_I$:

$$\begin{aligned} |a, t\rangle_I &= e^{iH_0 t/\hbar} |a, t\rangle = e^{iH_0 t/\hbar} U(t, t_0) |a, t_0\rangle \\ &= \underbrace{e^{iH_0 t/\hbar} U(t, t_0) e^{-iH_0 t_0/\hbar}}_{U_I(t, t_0)} |a, t_0\rangle_I \end{aligned}$$

plug in $U(t, t_0)$:

$$\begin{aligned} U_I(t, t_0) &= \mathbb{1} + \frac{1}{i\hbar} \int_{t_0}^t dt' V_I(t') U_I(t', t_0) \\ &= \mathbb{1} + \frac{1}{i\hbar} \int_{t_0}^t dt_1 V_I(t_1) \end{aligned}$$

$$\frac{1}{(\hbar)^2} \int_{t_0}^t dt_2 \int_{t_0}^{t_2} dt_1 V_I(t_2) V_I(t_1) + \dots$$

where,

$$V_I(t) = e^{iH_0 t / \hbar} V(t) e^{-iH_0 t / \hbar}$$

$$|n\rangle \xrightarrow{\mathbb{I}} V_I(t') |n\rangle$$

